

3D_vision

1D

1. Projective geometry on a line, P^2 .
2. In a 1D world, a point in homogeneous coordinates can be represented as $x' = \begin{pmatrix} x_1 \\ x_2 \end{pmatrix}$, **1 degrees of freedom**.
3. if $x_2 = 0$, the point will be a point at infinity, or an ideal point.
4. A projective transformation of a line is represented by $H_{2 \times 2}$, i.e.
 1. $x' = H_{2 \times 2}x$
 2. $H_{2 \times 2}$ has **three degrees of freedom**, corresponding to four elements less one for scaling and can be computed from three points.
5. Cross ratio:
 1. $Cross(x_1, x_2, x_3, x_4) = \frac{|x_1 x_2| |x_3 x_4|}{|x_1 x_3| |x_2 x_4|}$, where $x_i x_j = \det \begin{bmatrix} x_{i1} & x_{j1} \\ x_{i2} & x_{j2} \end{bmatrix}$
 2. $x' = H_{2 \times 2}x$ the cross ratio must be preserved, i.e. should be the same number.
 3. $Cross(x'_1, x'_2, x'_3, x'_4) = cross(x_1, x_2, x_3, x_4)$.
 4. Proof: substitute $x' = H_{2 \times 2}x$, into the formula $Cross(x'_1, x'_2, x'_3, x'_4)$.

2D

1. Homogenize a point in 2D $\begin{pmatrix} x \\ y \end{pmatrix}$ by adding a new dimension, $\begin{pmatrix} x \\ y \\ 1 \end{pmatrix}$ and replacing x with $\frac{x_1}{x_3}$ and y with $\frac{x_2}{x_3}$. Or equivalently add a new dimension and now can multiply all dimension by a scale k , $\begin{pmatrix} kx \\ ky \\ k \end{pmatrix} = \begin{pmatrix} x' \\ y' \\ w' \end{pmatrix}$.
2. Points at infinity:
 1. Homogeneous coordinates of the form $[x, y, 0]^T$ do not correspond to a point in the Cartesian plane.
 2. They correspond to the unique point at infinity in the direction $[x, y]^T$.
 3. Consider the homogenous coordinates $[a + tx, b + ty, 1]$ or equivalently $[\frac{a}{t} + x, \frac{b}{t} + y, \frac{1}{t}]^T$.
 4. As t tends to infinity, homogeneous coordinates become $[x, y, 0]^T$.
3. From the equation of a line in 2D,

$$ax + by + c = 0$$
4. $a(kx) + b(ky) + c(k) = 0$

$$ax_1 + bx_2 + cx_3 = 0$$

$$l_1 x_1 + l_2 x_2 + l_3 x_3 = 0$$
5. In P^2 both a line $\begin{pmatrix} l_1 \\ l_2 \\ l_3 \end{pmatrix}$ and a point $\begin{pmatrix} x_1 \\ x_2 \\ x_3 \end{pmatrix}$ has **two degrees of freedom**.
6. Intersection of a point and a line or a line and a point in homogeneous coordinates,

$$l^T x = 0$$
7. line formed by two points
 1. algebraic derivation

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$$l_1x_1 + l_2x_2 + l_3x_3 = 0$$

$$l_1x'_1 + l_2x'_2 + l_3x'_3 = 0$$

$$\frac{l_1}{l_3} \frac{x_1}{x_3} + \frac{l_2}{l_3} \frac{x_2}{x_3} + 1 = 0$$

$$\frac{l_1}{l_3} \frac{x'_1}{x'_3} + \frac{l_2}{l_3} \frac{x'_2}{x'_3} + 1 = 0$$

$$ua + vb = -1$$

$$uc + vd = -1$$

$$\begin{bmatrix} a & b \\ c & d \end{bmatrix} \begin{bmatrix} u \\ v \end{bmatrix} = \begin{bmatrix} -1 \\ -1 \end{bmatrix}$$

$$\begin{bmatrix} u \\ v \end{bmatrix} = \frac{\begin{bmatrix} d & -b \\ -c & a \end{bmatrix} \begin{bmatrix} -1 \\ -1 \end{bmatrix}}{ad - bc}$$

$$u = \frac{l_1}{l_3} = \frac{x_2x'_3 - x'_2x_3}{x_1x'_2 - x_2x'_1}$$

$$v = \frac{l_2}{l_3} = \frac{x'_1x_3 - x_1x'_3}{x_1x'_2 - x_2x'_1}$$

$$l = x \times x'$$

2. line formed by two points is the normal vector of the plane formed by the two lines, by taking the cross product (geometric interpretation).

8. point intersected by two lines

1. algebraic derivation,

$$l_1x_1 + l_2x_2 + l_3x_3 = 0$$

$$l'_1x_1 + l'_2x_2 + l'_3x_3 = 0$$

1. Symmetrical to the derivation of line formed by two points case.

$$2. x = l \times l'$$

2. point intersected by two lines is the direction vector of a line formed by the intersection of two planes (geometric interpretation).

9. Conics

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$$ax^2 + bxy + cy^2 + dx + ey + f = 0$$

$$ax_1^2 + bx_1x_2 + cx_2^2 + dx_1 + ex_2 + f = 0$$

- Representation of a conic, 5 dof

$$\begin{pmatrix} a \\ b \\ c \\ d \\ e \\ f \end{pmatrix}$$

- To represent the relationship between conic and points, we write

$$x^T C x = 0$$

$$C = \begin{bmatrix} a & b/2 & d/2 \\ b/2 & c & e/2 \\ d/2 & e/2 & f \end{bmatrix}$$

- The intrinsic camera parameters matrix is an example of a conic (has 5 dof).
- C is a homogeneous representation of a conic.
- Only ratios of the matrix elements are important, multiplying C by a non-zero scalar has no effect.
- The conic has **five degrees of freedom** which can be thought of the ratios $a : b : c : d : e : f$.
- Each point $x_i = (x_i, y_i)$ places one constraint on the conic coefficients:

$$ax_i^2 + bx_iy_i + cy_i^2 + dx_i + ey_i + f = 0$$

- Where

$$c = (a, b, c, d, e, f)^T$$

is the conic C represented by a 6-vector.

$$\begin{bmatrix} x_1^2 & x_1 y_1 & y_1^2 & x_1 & y_1 & 1 \\ & & \dots & & & \\ & & \dots & & & \\ & & \dots & & & \\ & & \dots & & & \end{bmatrix} \begin{pmatrix} a \\ b \\ c \\ d \\ e \\ f \end{pmatrix} = 0$$

- The $A_{5 \times 6}$. The conic is a null vector of this 5×6 matrix. Can be solved using SVD, and taking the eigenvector of V corresponding to the smallest eigenvalue, i.e. the one with the least principal component.
- This shows that a conic is determined uniquely (up to scale) by five points in general.

	Dual	

point	line	
conic	dual conic	

10. Tangent line to conics:

1. Intersection of point x and tangent line: $l^T x = 0$
2. Intersection of point and conic: $x^T C x = 0$
3. get $l^T x = x^T (C x) = 0$, recall $x^T l = l^T x$.
4. Therefore $l = C x$.

11. Dual conic, based on the definition of a point conic, $x^T C x = 0$, a line conic would have the form: $l^T C^* l = 0$. Where l is a tangent to the conic C .

12.

Conic	Dual Conic
\$x^T C x = 0\$	\$l^T C^* l = 0\$

14. A dual conic has **five degrees of freedom**, and can be computed from five lines.

15. $l^T x = 0$,

$$\begin{aligned} x^T C x &= 0 \\ \text{since } l &= C x, \text{ this implies} \\ x &= C^{-1} l \\ (C^{-1} l)^T C (C^{-1} l) &= 0 \\ l^T C^{-T} C C^{-1} l &= 0 \\ l^T C^{-T} l &= 0 \end{aligned}$$

- Recall

$$(A^T)^{-1} = (A^{-1})^T$$

if A is an $n \times n$ invertible matrix. Since C is symmetric $C^{-1} = C^{-T}$.

16. Degenerate conic

1. first degenerate conic: A degenerate conic made of 2 straight lines.

1. $C = l m^T + m l^T$
2. l and m are lines. Points on l satisfy $l^T x = 0$, similarly $m^T x = 0$. The two lines themselves is the conic.
3. Proof: $x^T C x = x^T (l m^T + m l^T) x = (x^T l)(m^T x) + (x^T m)(l^T x) = 0$
4. which consists of $x^T l = l^T x = l_1 x_1 + l_2 x_2 + l_3$.
5. and $m^T x = x^T m = m_1 x_1 + m_2 x_2 + m_3 x_3$.
6. has $\text{rank}(C) = 2$.

2. Second degenerate conic: made of one line or two duplicate lines.

1. $C = l l^T + l l^T$
2. Similarly we have $l^T x = 0, x^T x = 0$
3. $x^T C x = x^T (l l^T + l l^T) x = (x^T l)(l^T x) + (x^T l)(l^T x) = 0$
4. which consists of $x^T l = l^T x = l_1 x_1 + l_2 x_2 + l_3$
5. has $\text{rank}(C) = 1$.

3. Third degenerate conic: made of two points.

1. $C^* = x y^T + y x^T$ has $\text{rank}(C) = 2$.

4. Fourth degenerate conic: made of a point or two duplicate points.

1. $C^* = xx^T + xx^T$ has $\text{rank}(C)=1$.

Degenerate Conic	Degenerate Dual Conic
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$m^T l + l^T m$	$x^T y + y^T x$
$l^T l + l^T l$	$x^T x + x^T x$

17. Planar projective transformations for points

1. Projectivity, mapping from P^2 to P^2 .

2. such that three points x_1, x_2 , and x_3 . Why three? (because a plane in 3D has three degrees of freedom?) lie on the same line if and only if $h(x_1), h(x_2), h(x_3)$ do.

3. $x' = hx \Rightarrow x = h^{-1}x'$.

4. Define planar projective transformation, a transformation matrix for objects in 2D plane for example points or lines (in homogeneous coordinates, knowing points or lines have two degrees of freedom, and bumping the dimension by one, i.e. from 2 to 3 coordinates, and keeping the same number of dof), we have:

5.
$$\begin{pmatrix} x'_1 \\ x'_2 \\ x'_3 \end{pmatrix} = \begin{bmatrix} h_{11} & h_{12} & h_{13} \\ h_{21} & h_{22} & h_{23} \\ h_{31} & h_{32} & h_{33} \end{bmatrix} \begin{pmatrix} x_1 \\ x_2 \\ x_3 \end{pmatrix}$$

6. or $x' = Hx$. H is a 3×3 matrix, and is homogeneous (only the ratio of the matrix elements is significant).

7. H has **eight degrees of freedom**, nine minus one for scaling.

18. Projective transformation of a line

1. $l^T x = 0, l'^T x' = 0$

2. $l^T (H^{-1}H)x = 0$

3. $(H^{-T}l)^T x' = 0 \Rightarrow l' = H^{-T}l$

4. Under a projective transformation H , the points that lie on a line l , will be transformed to points that lie on the line $l' = H^{-T}l$

5. This means under the point transformation $x' = Hx$, a line transforms as $l' = H^{-T}l$ or $l'^T = l^T H^{-1}$.

19. Projective transformation of a conic

1. projective transformation of a point, $x' = Hx \Rightarrow x = H^{-1}x'$

2. $x^T C x = (H^{-1}x')^T C (H^{-1}x') = x'^T (H^{-T} C H^{-1}) x'$

3. under a point transformation $x' = Hx$, a conic transforms according to $C' = H^{-T} C H^{-1}$

20. Projective transformation of a dual conic

1. $l' = H^{-T}l \Rightarrow l = H^T l'$

2. $l^T C^* l = (H^T l')^T C^* (H^T l') = l'^T (H C^* H^T) l'$

3. a dual conic C^* transforms to $C'^* = H C^* H^T$

21. Hierarchy of transformations:

1. General transformation for objects in a 2D plane such as points and lines $H_{3 \times 3}$, with *eight degrees of freedom*

2. Isometries: transform that preserves Euclidean distance, rotate and translate figures.

1. $x' = H_E x = \begin{bmatrix} R & t \\ 0^T & 1 \end{bmatrix} x = \begin{bmatrix} \epsilon c \theta & -s \theta & t_x \\ \epsilon s \theta & c \theta & t_y \\ 0 & 0 & 1 \end{bmatrix} x$, where $\epsilon = \pm 1$.

2. $\epsilon = +1$, orientation preserving.

3. $\epsilon = -1$, orientation reversing.

4. Invariants: length, angle, area.

5. H_E has **three degrees of freedom**.

6. *preserving lengths*.

3. Isotropic scaling, similarities additionally (isotropic) scale figures:

1. H_S has **four degrees of freedom**.

2. can be computed from two point correspondences.

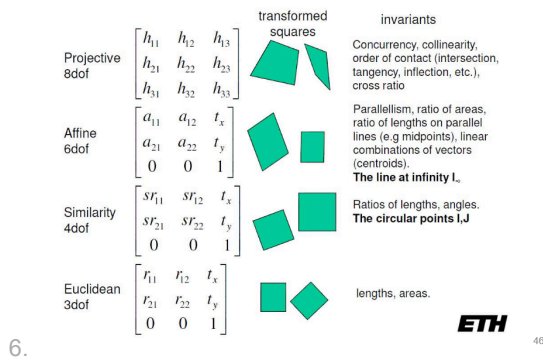
3. *preserving ratio of lengths, angles*.

4. Affinity transform, additionally non-isotropic scale figures:

1. H_A has **six degrees of freedom**.

2. can be computed from three point correspondences
3. Note: each point correspondence would give **two degrees of freedom**, hence why the three points will be sufficient to compute this **six degrees of freedom** matrix.
4. can always be decomposed as:
 1. $A = R(\theta)R(-\phi)DR(\phi)$
 2. This decomposition follows directly from singular value decomposition.
5. *Preserving ratio of lengths on parallel lines, parallel lines*
5. Projective transformation: a non-singular linear transformation of homogeneous coordinates, additionally move the line at infinity.
 1. $x' = H_P x = \begin{bmatrix} A & t \\ \vec{v}^T & u \end{bmatrix} x$ where vector $\vec{v} = (v_1, v_2)^T$ and u can be 0.
 2. Note: it is not always possible to make $[v^T \quad u]$ to be $[0 \quad 0 \quad 1]$.
 3. H_P has nine elements with only the ratio of its elements is significant, so the transformation has **eight degrees of freedom**.
 4. can be computed from four point correspondences, with no three collinear on either plane.
 5. It is not possible to distinguish between orientation preserving and orientation reversing projectivities in P^2 .
 6. Decomposition of a projective transformation into a pure projective, a pure affine transform and a similarity:
 1. $H = H_S H_A H_P = \begin{bmatrix} sR & t \\ 0^T & 1 \end{bmatrix} \begin{bmatrix} K & 0 \\ 0^T & 1 \end{bmatrix} \begin{bmatrix} I & 0 \\ v^T & u \end{bmatrix} = \begin{bmatrix} A & t \\ v^T & u \end{bmatrix}$
 2. A is a non-singular matrix given by: $A = sRK + tv^T$
 1. where s is the scale
 2. R is the rotation matrix
 3. K is an upper triangular matrix
 4. t is translation vector
 5. v^T is a 2×1 vector
 3. Decomposition is valid if $u \neq 0$, and is unique if s is chosen positive.
 7. *Preserving cross ratios.*

Hierarchy of 2D Transformations



3D

1. Many properties and entities of P^3 are straightforward generalizations of those of P^2 . Example: The homogeneous coordinates of a point in P^3 Euclidean 3-space is augmented with an extra dimension in P^2 .
 1. Note: two lines always intersect on P^2 , but not always on P^3 .
2. Points in P^3
 1. A point in 3-space represented in homogeneous coordinates as 4-vector, i.e.
 2. $x = (x_1, x_2, x_3, x_4)^T$ with $x_4 \neq 0$
 3. represents the point $(x, y, z)^T$ of R^3 with inhomogeneous coordinates
 4. $x = x_1/x_4, y = x_2/x_4, z = x_3/x_4$. Homogeneous points with $x_4 = 0$ represent points at infinity.
3. Projective transformation of points in P^3 :
 1. A projective transformation acting on P^3 is a linear transformation on x by a non-singular 4×4 matrix: $x' = H_{4 \times 4} x$.
 2. The matrix H is homogeneous and has **fifteen degrees of freedom**, sixteen elements less on for scaling.
 3. As in P^2 space, the mapping is a collineation (lines are mapped to lines, which preserves incidence relations such as intersection point of a line with a plane, and order of contact).
4. Planes in P^3

1. A plane in 3-space may be written as:

$$1. \Pi_1 x + \Pi_2 y + \Pi_3 z + \Pi_4 = 0$$

2. Homogeneizing by $x = x_1/x_4, y = x_2/x_4, z = x_3/x_4$.

$$3. \Pi_1 x_1 + \Pi_2 x_2 + \Pi_3 x_3 + \Pi_4 x_4 = 0$$

$$4. \Pi^T x = 0$$

2. Which expresses that the key point x is on the plane $\Pi = (\Pi_1, \Pi_2, \Pi_3, \Pi_4)^T$.

3. Only three independent ratios $\Pi_1 : \Pi_2 : \Pi_3 : \Pi_4$ of the plane coefficients are significant, i.e. **three degrees of freedom**.

4. The first 3 components of Π correspond to the plane normal of Euclidean geometry, i.e. $n = (\Pi_1, \Pi_2, \Pi_3)^T$.

5. Points in P^3

1. Analogous to a line in P^2 , we can rewrite $\Pi^T x = 0$.

$$2. n \cdot x + d = 0.$$

3. where $x = (x, y, z)^T, x_4 = 1$ and $d = \Pi_4$.

4. In this form $\frac{d}{\|\vec{n}\|}$ is the distance of the plane from the origin.

1. Proof: using analogy to the line in P^2 .

2. equation of line in P^2 in *inhomogeneous* coordinates: $\begin{pmatrix} a \\ b \end{pmatrix}^T \begin{pmatrix} x \\ y \end{pmatrix} + c = 0$. Where $\vec{n} = \begin{pmatrix} a \\ b \end{pmatrix}$ and any point on the line $\vec{v} = \begin{pmatrix} x \\ y \end{pmatrix}$.

3. closest distance from line to the origin d is the dot product of a point on the line $\vec{v}$ with the unit normal vector.

$$4. d = \frac{|\vec{v} \cdot \vec{n}|}{\|\vec{n}\|} = \frac{c}{\sqrt{a^2 + b^2}}$$

5. extending this case to the plane in P^3 we have the distance from the plane to the origin as $\frac{d}{\|\vec{n}\|}$, where $d = \Pi_4$ and

$$\|\vec{n}\| = \sqrt{\Pi_1^2 + \Pi_2^2 + \Pi_3^2}.$$

5. Again similarly, under point transformation $x' = Hx$, a plane transforms as $\boxed{\Pi' = H^{-T}\Pi}$.

6. Geometric relations between planes and points and lines:

1. Plane defined uniquely by the *join of three points* (not collinear), or the *join of a line and point* (not incident), in general position.

2. Two distinct planes intersect in a *unique line*.

3. Three distinct planes intersect in a *unique point*.

7. Three points define a plane

$$1. \vec{x}_1^T \vec{\pi} = 0$$

$$2. \vec{x}_2^T \vec{\pi} = 0$$

$$3. \vec{x}_3^T \vec{\pi} = 0$$

$$4. \begin{bmatrix} \vec{x}_1^T \\ \vec{x}_2^T \\ \vec{x}_3^T \end{bmatrix} \vec{\pi} = 0 \Rightarrow \begin{bmatrix} \vec{x}_1^T \vec{\pi} \\ \vec{x}_2^T \vec{\pi} \\ \vec{x}_3^T \vec{\pi} \end{bmatrix} = \begin{bmatrix} 0 \\ 0 \\ 0 \end{bmatrix}$$

5. The 3×4 matrix $[\vec{x}_1, \vec{x}_2, \vec{x}_3]^T$ has rank 3 when the points are in general positions, i.e. linearly independent.

6. The plane Π defined by the points is obtained uniquely (up to scale) as the 1-dimensional (right nullspace).

7. If the matrix $[\vec{x}_1, \vec{x}_2, \vec{x}_3]^T$ has only rank of 2, and consequently the null space is 2-dimensional.

1. Then the points are collinear, and define a pencil of planes with the line of collinear points as axis.

8. Three planes define a point

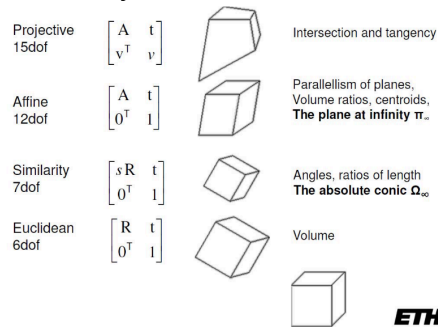
1. The intersection of three unique planes $\vec{\Pi}_i$ defines a point $\vec{x}$ and can be computed as the right nullspace of the 3×4 matrix, compose of the planes as rows.

$$2. \begin{bmatrix} \Pi_1^T \\ \Pi_2^T \\ \Pi_3^T \end{bmatrix} \vec{x} = 0$$

$$3. \text{let } A = \begin{bmatrix} \Pi_1^T \\ \Pi_2^T \\ \Pi_3^T \end{bmatrix}, \text{ then } \begin{bmatrix} a_1^T \vec{x} \\ a_2^T \vec{x} \\ a_3^T \vec{x} \end{bmatrix} = \begin{bmatrix} 0 \\ 0 \\ 0 \end{bmatrix}$$

4. 8 possibilities of intersection of 3 planes, one $\text{rank}(A)=3$, four $\text{rank}(A)=2$, three $\text{rank}(A)=1$.

Hierarchy of 3D Transformations



9.

Epipolar geometry [2]

1. motivation: we don't always have a checkerboard to do camera calibration to get camera parameters (intrinsic and extrinsic), and then do triangulation to get 3D points from 2D. What we can do is apply epipolar geometry to get camera parameters from two camera images (epipolar geometry works for $n \geq 2$ images, the theory can be extended to multiple views/images). Now we concern with number of images = 2.
2. We only have points from multiple images, then we use epipolar geometry (don't need to prepare checkerboard or 3D object). We only have points from multiple images then we apply epipolar geometry then we will get essential or fundamental matrix. Based on this essential and fundamental matrix we triangulate points from multiple images to get 3D points, but this has ambiguity up to scale.
3. With checkerboard, we have the known 3D measurement, 3D position, actual size of checkerboard. But using epipolar geometry we do not have any known 3D measurement, it has scale ambiguity.
4. Images from internet often do not have any calibration information. Although have scale ambiguity, the second pipeline (using epipolar geometry) is widely used and is very practical.
5. If we know extrinsics with camera calibrations and checkerboard:
 1. e.g. you calibrate cameras with checkerboards
 2. skip all things we'll learn today
 3. just triangulate (we'll learn this later) 2D points to the 3D space
6. If we do not know extrinsics (today's focus)
 1. e.g., taking a video with your mobile phone without any calibrations/checkerboards.
 2. Epipolar geometry!
 3. We get essential/fundamental matrices
 4. We do not have checkerboard, which provides actual 3D measurements -> we get extrinsics up to scale.
7. Epipolar Geometry:
 1. Baseline
 1. The line between the two camera centers O_1 and O_2 .
 2. Epipolar plane
 1. Defined by P , O_1 , and O_2 ; contains baseline and P
 3. Epipoles (e and e')
 1. intersection of baseline and image plane
 2. Projection of the other camera center
 4. Epipolar lines
 1. intersection of epipolar plane with the image plane
8. Epipolar constraint:
 1. The relationship between corresponding image points
 1. The world reference system aligned with the left camera (assumption).
 2. The right camera has orientation R and offset t .
 3. Left camera projection matrices:
 - $M = K \begin{bmatrix} I & 0 \end{bmatrix}$
 - $\vec{p} = M\vec{P} = \begin{bmatrix} u \\ v \\ 1 \end{bmatrix}$
 - Right camera projection matrices:
 - $M' = K' \begin{bmatrix} R & \vec{t} \end{bmatrix}$

$$\bullet \quad \vec{p}' = M' \vec{P} = \begin{bmatrix} u' \\ v' \\ 1 \end{bmatrix}$$

References:

1. 3D vision NUS, Prof. Lee Gim Hee.
2. Lecture 5, Introduction to Computer Vision (2025-2), Prof Gyeonsik Moon, Korea University.
3. Computer Vision, Projective Geometry in 2D, Lars Schmidt-Thieme, University of Hildesheim.